

ILOLO IZU

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI Product Engineering Lead with dual ownership of full-stack marketplace engineering and AI product strategy. Architects and ships production LLM agents and chat systems (Claude/Anthropic, LangChain, LangGraph, MCP), translating customer and stakeholder insight into roadmap-driving AI features. MBA candidate, Rice University Jones Graduate School of Business; 4x NCAA All-American bringing a disciplined, competitive edge to execution.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Sass, React.js, React Native, Angular.js, Vue.js, Node.js, GraphQL, RxJS, NgRx, Material-UI, Bootstrap

AI & Agents: Claude (Anthropic), ChatGPT, LangChain, LangGraph, LangSmith, Model Context Protocol (MCP), OpenClaw, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Prompt Engineering, LLM Pipeline Orchestration & Evaluation

Backend & Data: FastAPI, Sails.js, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, WebSocket, REST APIs

Cloud & Tools: AWS (Lambda, S3, Glue, EC2), DocuSign API, Stripe, Metabase, Cypress, Playwright, Jira, Linear, Agile/Kanban, Honeycomb, PagerDuty, Splunk, Adobe Premiere Pro, Photoshop

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lawtrades *Remote*

AI Product Engineering Lead — Marketplace & AI Chat Platform Jan. 2026 – Present

- **AI Platform Architecture:** Own dual mandate across full-stack marketplace engineering and AI product strategy for Lawtrades Chat, architecting a production Python/FastAPI/LangGraph/LangChain AI backend with multi-provider LLM routing (Anthropic, OpenRouter) and automatic failover, supporting 10K+ monthly AI-assisted conversations.
- **Role-Aware Personalization:** Define and drive a role-aware AI personalization layer spanning 5 user personas (Talent, Client, Founder/SMB, Law Firm Owner, Internal/Ops), scoping distinct AI behaviors, prompts, and data-access boundaries to improve response relevance and user trust platform-wide.
- **AI Product Roadmap:** Own a 3-phase AI product roadmap (AI Contract Review Copilot, Matter Memory & Communications Copilot, Legal Ops Automation) through Q4 2026, running structured customer and internal stakeholder calls to validate use cases and prioritize the backlog.
- **Customer-Driven Discovery:** Partner directly with customers, Support, and Ops via live calls and escalation reviews to surface product gaps; identified a critical workflow gap from a client-support escalation and scoped a net-new MCP-based engagement management tool, cutting live-engagement update turnaround from days to hours.
- **Performance Engineering:** Run latency benchmarking on the AI chat platform, designing and validating a triage-gate architecture against baseline production timing that cut end-to-end response latency by 30%+, improving perceived responsiveness for concurrent users.
- **Execution & Delivery:** Author and self-assign 15+ Linear tickets end-to-end (PRDs, architecture, acceptance criteria) spanning hiring-flow improvements, candidate reactivation logic, and DocuSign contract-sync automation, operating as sole PM and lead engineer across concurrent workstreams.
- **AI Infrastructure:** Self-host and maintain an AI gateway (OpenClaw) on AWS EC2 to prototype and evaluate LLM providers ahead of production rollout, accelerating experimentation cycles for new AI product capabilities.

Vanguard *Hybrid — Plano, TX*

Full Stack Software Engineer | Application Developer 2 Jan. 2025 – Dec. 2025

- Acted as de facto Product Engineer for key Auto-Invest initiatives, translating business goals into technical deliverables and aligning cross-functional teams on product vision and delivery timelines.
- Spearheaded performance optimization of the Auto-Invest app, improving load time by 70% through refactoring Angular's change detection strategy — directly enhancing user experience and engagement.
- Developed and maintained the “Manage the Loop” feature using React.js, bridging Jira and Appian to enable advisors to seamlessly monitor task progress and reduce manual reconciliation.
- Built serverless backend with AWS Lambda, S3, and AWS Glue to process 2M+ records daily, cutting infrastructure costs by 20% while maintaining sub-second latency.
- Defined, monitored, and reported SLOs/SLIs across six microservices, ensuring 99.95% uptime for 10K+ daily advisor interactions.

- Delivered departmental knowledge-sharing session on performance optimization for 30+ engineers; co-led quarterly Honeycomb and PagerDuty training series for developers and PMs.

Vanguard *Hybrid — Malvern, PA*

Application Developer I *Aug. 2023 – Dec. 2024*

- Contributed to the New Investor IRA Experience, driving \$250M in investments, a 4% increase in overall investment rates, and 22% adoption of Target Retirement Funds by new clients.
- Optimized order validation for quick transactions and automated investment ETF pages, increasing validation accuracy by 20% and reducing processing times.
- Enhanced accessibility on the New IRA Page from 85% to 95% compliance with WCAG standards; contributed to PagerDuty on-call rotations, reducing MTTR by 10%.
- Co-created a mentorship program for new crew through Vanguard's Black at Vanguard ERG; mentored a junior engineer on product sense, career growth, and cross-team visibility.

Resilia *Remote*

Software Engineer I, Full Stack *Jan. 2022 – June 2023*

- Full-stack engineer in TypeScript, Node.js, GraphQL, ReactJS, and Material UI; implemented Funder Migration Script enabling seamless user transitions and strengthening nonprofit platform operations.
- Founded Resilia Black in Tech, an internal affinity group for people of color.

RippleMatch *Remote*

Associate Software Engineer, Full Stack *May 2022 – Oct. 2022*

- Built recruiter analytics dashboard enhancements with filters and tagging API integration; optimized candidate tracking and query handling, reducing load bottlenecks on email link tracking.

Jack in the Box — Izu Group Restaurants *Houston, TX*

Product Owner | Internal Auditor & Quality Analyst *2015 – Present*

- Conducted detailed analyses of speed of service and food cost metrics; managed payroll for all employees.
- Software & Solutions Engineering Intern (2019–2021): Automated KPI dashboards with JavaScript + Google Sheets API, reducing errors by 40%; supported Qu Software pre-sales team in onboarding and solution design.

EDUCATION

Rice University — Jones Graduate School of Business *Houston, TX*

Master of Business Administration (MBA) *2026 – 2027*

Texas A&M University *College Station, TX*

B.S. Allied Health | Minor in Business Administration, Information Systems *2019*

Flatiron School

Full-Stack Web Development Program, Computer Science *2022*

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Stylo — Consulting Software Engineer (2025–Present): Mobile platform connecting stylists, suit tailors, and style consultants with clients; built cross-platform app with React Native and Supabase with role-based access and scalable infrastructure.

Space City Sneakers — Full Stack (Apr. 2022): Full-stack sneaker marketplace with interactive maps and social media integration — ReactJS, Ruby on Rails, Three.js, Redux, Google Maps API, and Twitter API.

Other Projects: achievelt • Take a Hint • Oishii Me Up • Elden Ring Wiki App

AWARDS & HONORS

Texas A&M Distinguished Letterman's Award • Buck Weirus Award Nominee • Spring 2017 Dean's List • SEC Academic Honor Roll • Athletic Director's Honor Roll • 2x SEC Athlete of the Week (2018 & 2019) • 2017 SEC Team Champion • 2018 Indoor & Outdoor 4x400m SEC Champions • 4x NCAA All-American • 2x First Team All-SEC • 2018 & 2019 Indoor and 2018 Outdoor 4x400m National Runner-Up, NCAA Championship